

The Landing Runbook

An FDE's first 90 days embedded inside a customer

A runbook is operational — exact steps, checklists, and gates. The cookbook is the method; this is the field manual for a single FDE landing a single account. Repeatable across every engagement.

Pre-Landing — Before Day 1 on Site

- ☐ Account brief from the regional head: customer, stated scope, commercial frame, known risks.
- ☐ Identify the offshore pod that will scale behind you; meet the pod lead.
- ☐ Confirm the commercial/contract boundary (what's in scope, decision rights, IP).
- ☐ Read everything the customer has shared — architecture, docs, roadmap — before you arrive.

Gate: you can state the customer's likely load-bearing gap in one sentence before day 1.

Phase 1 — Listen & Diagnose (Weeks 1–2) • Clarity

Objective: understand the customer's system better than their job description does.

- ☐ Meet the customer's technical decision-maker and map the real org.
- ☐ Walk their existing system live; find where 'the product lives between the tools.'

Run the four recon questions (adapt per domain):

1. Where is correctness/validation enforced today — inline or batch?
 2. Where does authoritative state live — data layer or rendering/scene/UI layer?
 3. What AI/agentic capability exists today vs. is assumed?
 4. How is regulated/external data exchanged today?
- ☐ Map the gap to one OS Fabric™ layer.
 - ☐ Validate the diagnosis live: 'here's what I see — tell me where I'm wrong.'

Gate: customer agrees on the problem and wants your architecture.

Phase 2 — Land a Working Slice (Weeks 3–6) • Build

Objective: running code on their stack that proves the thesis.

- ☐ Scope the thinnest end-to-end vertical slice that proves the architecture.
- ☐ Freeze the contracts (data model, payloads, command set) as lightweight ADRs.
- ☐ Build on the customer's actual stack — real infra, not a sandbox demo.
- ☐ Enforce governed-AI discipline: model proposes, deterministic gate disposes.
- ☐ Instrument health, metrics, governance from the first commit.
- ☐ Label everything built / proven / next — no overclaiming.

Gate: customer-validated working slice runs on their stack.

Phase 3 — Pull the Pod In (Weeks 5–8, overlapping) · Velocity

Objective: scale delivery behind earned trust — no handoff gap.

- ☐ Define the offshore-pull point: what the pod takes now that the slice is trusted.
- ☐ Onboard the offshore pod behind you — you stay the single customer owner.
- ☐ Bring StatusNeo automation IP: Agents Library, AI-Native SDLC, agentic CI/CD, autonomous QA.
- ☐ Set up the delivery cadence (the customer's rhythm, not the GCC's).
- ☐ Instrument the correction-delta flywheel.

Gate: offshore velocity is landing behind you; no trust gap; account scaling.

Phase 4 — Govern & Expand (Weeks 9–12) · Improvement

Objective: durable, governed, growing account.

- ☐ Stand up continuous governance: observability, compliance, SLO/SLA loops.
- ☐ Score the account on the (extended) AI Maturity Index.
- ☐ Measure time-to-trust and baseline expansion opportunities.
- ☐ Identify the next adjacent problem to land (land → expand).
- ☐ Package the engagement as a reference case.
- ☐ Feed learnings back into the FDE Loop™ and this runbook.

Gate: account is self-sustaining, governed, expanding, referenceable.

The Break-Glass Rules (When an Engagement Wobbles)

- **Customer doubts it's real?** → show running code on their stack + health/observability. Working software ends doubt.
- **Scope creep?** → return to the frozen ADRs and the agreed slice. Expand deliberately, not reactively.
- **Offshore handoff friction?** → the FDE owns the seam; never let the customer feel a gap. Re-anchor on the single-owner model.
- **Architecture disagreement with the customer?** → 'here's what I'd measure before we decide.' Never bluff; decision rights stay with the customer.
- **Regulated-data risk surfaces?** → stop, escalate, govern first. In healthcare/BFSI/defense, correctness and compliance precede velocity, always.

What “Done” Means at Day 90

A single FDE has: diagnosed the real problem, landed a customer-validated slice on the customer's stack, pulled an offshore pod in behind earned trust, stood up governance, and identified the expansion path — producing one referenceable, scaling, governed account.

That is one unit of the FDE practice. Repeat across accounts, regions, and verticals.